ZHAOXU SUI

Updated August 2026

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2025 | 2024 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University 2024 - Present
PhD Candidate, Geography
Advisor: Dr. Anthony C. Robinson
Research Interests: Cartography, Geovisualization, Digital Humanities, Political Geography
Lab Affiliations: GeoGraphics Lab

University of Oregon 2022 –2024
Master of Science, Geography
Advisor: Dr. Carolyn S. Fish
Lab Affiliations: Cartofish Lab, S3C Lab, Infographics Lab

University of Minnesota 2019 - 2021
Bachelor of Science, Geography
Minors: GIS, Population Studies, Interdisciplinary Design
GPA: 3.99/4.0, Graduated with High Distinction, Dean's List 2019-2021
Capstone Project: Flooding Risk Assessment in Jinan, China, in ArcGIS Story Map

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Graduate Research Assistant 2025 - Present
Supervisor: Dr. Anthony C. Robinson
Department of Geography, The Pennsylvania State University
Project: Measuring Human Behavior and Ecological Dimensions of Pathogen Transmission for Outbreak Control and Prevention. *National Institutes of Health*. R01TW012434.

Graduate Research Assistant 2023
Supervisor: Dr. Carolyn S. Fish
Department of Geography, University of Oregon
Project: Why Conduct Cartographic Research: A Comparison of Cartographic Research Contributions in Four International Cartographic Association (ICA) Affiliated Journals.

Undergraduate Research Assistant 2021
Supervisor: Jeff Matson
Center for Urban and Regional Affairs (CURA), University of Minnesota
Project: Web Mapping Creative Enterprises in the city of Minneapolis

Undergraduate Research Assistant 2020 – 2021
Institute on the Environment, University of Minnesota
Project: Sweetie Pie – Urban Gardening on Northside Community, Minneapolis

PUBLICATIONS

ORCID 0009-0000-7754-3589

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Sui, Z. and Fish, C. (Accepted). Deconstructing Borders, Territories, and Toponyms: Cartographic Designs in the Political Disputed Territory of Sakhalin. *Cartographic Perspectives.*

Sui, Z. and Lessani, M. N. (2026). Towards Cartographic Design Pluralism: Centering Non-Latin Typographic Practices in Digital Mapping. *GeoHumanties. Outer Cartographies Forum.* https://doi.org/10.1080/2373566X.2026.2631449

Sui, Z., & Robinson, A. C. (2026). Digitally-mediated territorial imaginations: A deep learning approach to characterize online images of contested territories and place names. *Digital Geography and Society*, 100160. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.diggeo.2026.100160

Fish, C., Roth, R., Guidero, E., Raposo, P., **Sui, Z.** (2025). Why Conduct Cartographic Research: A Comparison of Cartographic Research Contributions in Four International Cartographic Association (ICA) Affiliated Journals. *International Journal of Cartography*: 10th Anniversary Issue. https://doi.org/10.1080/23729333.2025.2475411

Peer-Reviewed Extended Abstracts

Sui, Z. and Robinson, A.C. (Accepted). Making vivid maps: expressive geovisualization for representing spatial vulnerability. *Abstracts of EuroCarto 2026*. Brno, Czech Republic. September 9-11, 2026.

Sui, Z. (2025). Visualizing States Across Cartographic Designs. *Abstracts of the ICA*. https://doi.org/10.5194/ica-abs-10-277-2025

Sui, Z., & Fish, C. S. (2023). Endonyms or Exonyms: How map purpose, data source, and map language impact place naming on maps. *Abstracts of the ICA*, 6, 1–2. https://doi.org/10.5194/ica-abs-6-249-2023

Non-Peer Reviewed Articles and Book Reviews

Sui, Z. (2026). Review of *Body Maps: Improvising Meridians and Nerves in Global Chinese Medicine*. *Cartographic Perspectives, (108).* https://doi.org/10.14714/CP108.2111

Sui, Z., & Lessani, M. N. (2025). Design Principles of Kashida Justification: A Unique Technique in Arabic and Persian Mapping. *Cartographic Perspectives*, (107). https://doi.org/10.14714/CP107.2055

Sui, Z. (2025). Review of *The Rise and Fall of the National Atlas in the Twentieth Century*. *Cartographic Perspectives*, (107). https://doi.org/10.14714/CP107.2013

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATIONS

Conference Session Organization / Chair

Sui, Z. and Nawshin, N. T. (2026). Modern Methods in Mapmaking 1: Experimental Cartographies. *American Association of Geographers 2026 Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA*, March 21, 2026.

Sui, Z. (2025). Research and Design. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Louisville, KY*, October 16, 2025.

Houtman, L. and **Sui, Z.** (2024). Putting the Human back in Cartography: Designs and Practices. *American Association of Geographers 2024 Annual Meeting, Honolulu, HI*, April 18, 2024.

Conference Oral Presentations

Sui, Z. (2026). Expressive Geovisualization Techniques for Representing Spatial Vulnerability. *American Association of Geographers 2026 Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA*, March 19, 2026.

Chen, Y. and **Sui, Z.** (2026). Temporal Changes of Static Map Research and Practices in the Digital Era: Evidence from ICA-Affiliated Journals and Exhibitions. *American Association of Geographers 2026 Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, March 19, 2026.*

Sui, Z. (2025). Is AI good at reading maps? Envisioning AI-assisted content analysis. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Louisville, KY*, October 16, 2025.

Sui, Z. (2025). Characterizing the State across Cartographic Designs. *International Cartographic Conference, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada*, August 20, 2025.

Sui, Z. (2025). Characterizing State Narratives in Cartographic Designs. *American Association of Geographers (AAG) 2023 Annual Meeting, Detroit, MI*, March 24-28, 2025, & *No Boundaries Symposium, Penn State, State College, PA*, May 2025.

Sui, Z. (2024). Mapping the Transition: The Evolution and Resilience of Specialist Map Retailers around the world. *1st AsiaCarto Conference, Hong Kong, China*, December 11-13, 2024.

Kelso, N., Patterson, T., Plewe, B., **Sui, Z.** (2024). Rebuilding Natural Earth: An Updated Public Preview of Version 6. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Tacoma, WA*, October 16-19, 2024.

Sui, Z. (2024). Making a 3D relief globe. *North American Cartography Information Society (NACIS) Annual Conference, Tacoma, WA*, October 16-19, 2024.

Sui, Z. (2024). Deconstructing borders, fill-colors, and toponyms: cartography designs in the political disputed territory of Sakhalin. *American Association of Geographers (AAG) 2024 Annual Meeting, Honolulu, HI*, April 18, 2024.

Sui, Z. (2023). Secure Political Claim: How Japanese Regulate Map Labeling on Southern Sakhalin Island (Karafuto). *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference (NACIS), Pittsburgh, PA*, October 11-14, 2023.

Sui, Z. (2023). Endonyms or Exonyms: How map purpose, data source, and map language impact place naming on maps. *International Cartographic Conference, Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa*, August 14, 2023 & *American Association of Geographers (AAG) 2023 Annual Meeting, Denver, CO*, March 27, 2023.

Sui, Z. (2023) AI use in atlas projects. *Map AI Workshop, International Cartographic Conference (ICC), Stellenbosch, Western Cape, South Africa*, August 12, 2023.

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

$32,000	University Graduate Fellowship, Penn State	2024 - 2026
$222	AAG Cartography Specialty Group Student-Organized Session Funding	2026
$1,200	AAG-International Geographic Information Funds Scholarship Award	2026
$2,500	NACIS Student Travel Grants (Total)	2021 - 2025
$2,000	U.S. National Committee (USNC) to the ICC Travel Funding	2025
€400	International Cartographic Association (ICA) Scholarship for ICC 2025	2025
$75	No Boundaries Symposium Best Presentation Award 2nd Place	2025
	AsiaCarto Conference Best Presentation Award	2024
$1000	Carto. and Geographic Info. Society (CaGIS) Student Scholarship Award	2024
$1000	University of Oregon Rippey Grant Research Awards	2024
$5,000	Anne C. Wilson Graduate Fellowship, EMS College, Penn State	2024
$200	AAG Cartography Specialty Group Student-Organized Session Funding	2024
$300	AAG Cartography Specialty Group Masters Student Research Grant	2024
$250	AsiaCarto Conference Travel Grant with Registration Waiver	2024

$2,344	U.S. National Committee (USNC) to the ICC Travel Funding	2023
$875	Mather Fellowship, Department of Geography, University of Oregon	2023
$500	International Cartographic Association (ICA) Scholarship for ICC 2023	2023
$25,000	University of Minnesota Global Excellence Scholarship	2019 - 2021
$7,500	University of Minnesota Ecolab Sustainability Scholarship	2020
	Global 10th Place, 15th International Geography Olympiad	2018

SERVICE, LEADERSHIP, AND AFFLIATIONS

EMS Graduate Student Council, Penn State
Graduate Council Member 2025 –Present

North American Cartographic Information Society (NACIS)
Student Board Member 2025 – Present
Co-chair, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion 2026 – Present
Director, Mentor Program 2025 – Present

The Graduate Students in the Department of Geography (GSDOG), Penn State
Graduate Representative, Treasurer 2025 – 2026

Belonging, Dignity and Justice (BDJ) Committee, Department of Geography, Penn State
Student Representative 2025

American Association of Geographers (AAG)
Student Chair, Cartography Specialty Group 2023 – 2024

Associated Graduate Students in Geography (AGSG), University of Oregon
Colloquium Chair, Representative at Large 2023 – 2024
Social Chair, Treasurer 2022 – 2023

International Student and Scholar Services, University of Minnesota
International Student Ambassador 2020 – 2021

Journal Reviews
Cartographic Perspectives (1), Transactions of GIS (1), Scientific Reports (1)

Other Memberships
Cartographic and Geographic Information Society (CaGIS) 2024 – Present
Phi Beta Kappa Society, the University of Minnesota chapter 2021

WORK & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Cartographer 2024 – Present
GeoGraphics Lab, Penn State

- Commissioned Project: Millbrook Marsh Nature Center AR Sandbox (3D Printing/CNC)
- Commissioned Project: Mapping Repurposed Energy Projects on Disturbed U.S. Lands
- Commissioned Project: Millbrook Marsh Nature Center Site Map
- Commissioned Project: Millbrook Marsh Nature Center Waterways Oblique Map
- Commissioned Project: A series of maps on Christian Communities in Ming & Qing China
- Commissioned Project: A Reference map of Pennsylvania
- Commissioned Project: Memorial Map of David Myers and the Wildlands Conservancy
  - See this media coverage for more information
- Commissioned Project: PSU Online Geospatial Education Alumni Map
- Commissioned Project: Longitudinal School Attendance Boundary Survey Web Map
- Commissioned Project: Millbrook Marsh Nature Center Birding Map
- Commissioned Project: Map of French Villages in Mississippi Valley, 17-18th century
- Appointed Person for Bambu Lab H2C 3D Printer
- Participated Event: Arboretum Lab Visit
- Participated Event: Millbrook Marsh Earth Fest
- Participated Event: Community Mapping Day
- Participated Event: STAGES Lab Logo Design Night
- Participated Event: Thermal Printing Section of GIS Day Event
- Guest Workshop: Designing Reference Maps with ArcGIS Pro and Adobe Illustrator
- Mentorship: Julia Byrnes (Undergraduate / Geography)

Guest Lecturer on Designing Reference Maps 2026
Department of Geography, Penn State

- Geography 467: Applied Cartography Design

Graduate Student Mapping Assistant 2024
Department of Anthropology, University of Oregon

- Project Invisible No More! with Dr. Lynn Stephen
- Mapping Mesoamerican language speakers' presence in Oregon, Mexico, and Guatemala.

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2023 - 2024
Department of Geography, University of Oregon

- Geography 393 & 490: Data Driven Cartography
- Geography 481: GIS I

Guest Lecturer on ArcGIS Pro ModelBuilder 2024
Department of Geography, University of Oregon

- Geography 481: GIS I

Guest Lecturer on Cartographic Toponomy 2024

Department of Geography, University of Oregon
Geography 393: Data Driven Cartography

Graduate Student Cartographer 2022 – 2024
Infographics Lab, University of Oregon
Commissioned Project: Periodic Table of Cartography
Participated Project: Global Initiative of Ungulate Migrations (GIUM) Mapbox Base Map
Participated Project: Global Initiative of Ungulate Migrations (GIUM) Mapbox Animation
Participated Project: USGS Wild Migration Report Maps
Participated Event: GIS Day Event
Infographics Lab 2022-23 Lab Anthology

Undergraduate Student Mapping Assistant 2021
Regional Sustainable Development Partnerships, University of Minnesota
Commissioned Project: Lost Creek Hiking Trail with Bluff Country Hiking Club, MN.

CARTOGRAPHY AWARDS

Arthur Robinson Print Map Award
Cartographic and Geographic Information Society (CaGIS)
Copies are preserved at the Library of Congress, Washington D.C.

"Earth Transit" Honorable Mention 2024
"Travel Map of the World" Honorable Mention 2023
"Comprehensive Map of the World and Beyond" Honorable Mention 2021

Bill Loy Award for Excellence in Cartography
Infographics Lab, Department of Geography, University of Oregon

"Reference Atlas of the World" Honorable Mention 2023

U-Spatial Mapping Prize
Department of Geography, University of Minnesota

"Comprehensive Map of the World and Beyond" Most Ambitious Award 2021

SELECTED CARTOGRAPHY EXHIBITIONS

Sui, Z. (2025). Dynastic Masonry – Visualizing the Great Wall of China. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Louisville, KY*, October 15-17, 2025.

Sui, Z. (2024). What if China Adopted the US National Park Service System? *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Tacoma, WA*, October 16-19, 2024.

Sui, Z. (2024). Himalayan Mountainscapes. *British Cartographic Society Map Award Commended Entries*, October 16-19, 2024.

Sui, Z. (2024). Earth Transit. German Newsmedia *ZeitMagazin*, February 2024.

Sui, Z. (2023). Travel Map of the World. *Online Map Gallery of International Cartographic Conference, Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa, August 14, 2023.*

Sui, Z. (2022). The Sahara. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN*, October 19-22, 2022.

Sui, Z. (2021). Comprehensive Map of the World and Beyond. *North American Cartography Information Society Annual Conference, Oklahoma City, OK*, October 13-16, 2021.

VOLUNTEERING & COLLABORATIONS

Student Mentor, *GeoGraphics Lab, Penn State*	2025 - Present
Data Contributor, *Natural Earth Dataset*	2022 – Present
Graphic Designer, *GISphere*	2023 – Present
Cartographer, *Zanjarajuno Natural Reserve, Ecuador*	2024 - 2025
Cartographer, *Department of Anthropology, University of Oregon*	2024
Graduate Workshop Organizer, *Department of Geography, University of Oregon*	2023
Graphic Designer, *Huafeng Magazine Club, University of Oregon*	2022 –2024

SKILLS

GIS	ArcGIS Suite (Pro, Online, Desktop), Mapbox, QGIS
PROGRAMMING	Python(Geopandas, ArcPy), Javascript (d3)
GRAPHIC DESIGN	Adobe Suite (Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop), Procreate
3D MODELING	Blender, Cloud Compare (LiDAR), Bambu Studio
WEB DESIGN	HTML, CSS, Dora, Wix, Wordpress, ArcGIS Web Apps
LANGUAGES	**Chinese:** Native, **English:** Proficient, **Japanese:** Elementary